

Strategic Growth Through AI

PREPARED BY CHIEF AI OFFICER · CONFIDENTIAL

Académie Lafayette · Leveraging Generative AI to Scale Missouri's #1-Ranked French Immersion Network to 2,000+ Students

MISSOURI'S #1-RANKED SCHOOL · 99.7% STATE PERFORMANCE SCORE

501(C)(3) PUBLIC CHARTER · KANSAS CITY, MO



Company at a Glance

Académie Lafayette operates the largest public French immersion program in the United States, serving Pre-K through 12th grade across three Kansas City campuses. A 501(c)(3) nonprofit governed by an independent board, with Saint Louis University as charter authorizer through 2029.

\$21.4M

Revenue

FY2024 · 501(c)(3) Public Charter · IRS
Form 990

1,352

Students

Pre-K–12 · Three campuses · Kansas City,
MO

130

Employees

Staff from 23+ countries · ~\$10M in
salaries (51% of expenses)

25

Years Operating

Founded 1999 · Missouri's first charter
school

99.7%

State Performance

#1 of 550+ districts and charter schools in
Missouri · 2023–24

Leadership & Recognition

Superintendent Elimane Mbengue has led the school since 2012, earning the French government's **Chevalier dans l'Ordre des Palmes Académiques** and Ingram's 2024 Icon of Education.

Historic Bond Funding

The school recently secured **\$13.6 million in bond funding** through a historic partnership with Kansas City Public Schools—the first KCPS bond in nearly 60 years, approved with **85% voter support**.

The Opportunity

Three converging forces create an urgent and compelling case for AI transformation at Académie Lafayette.

Scale Without Proportional Cost Growth

Académie Lafayette is targeting **2,000+ students K–12** with its high school expansion, funded by \$1.3M in federal grants and \$1.5M from SchoolSmartKC. AI enables this growth without proportionally scaling administrative headcount—absorbing enrollment complexity, parent communication volume, and compliance reporting through automation rather than new hires.

Bilingual Talent Pipeline Advantage

With **47 of 50 states** reporting severe language teacher shortages, Académie Lafayette's ability to recruit French-speaking educators from a 23-country talent pool is its most critical competitive advantage—and its biggest operational bottleneck. AI-powered recruitment, retention analytics, and onboarding automation can transform this constraint into a scalable system.

Financial Resilience

The December 2024 **\$1.7M state funding clawback** exposed the fragility of charter funding mechanisms. AI-driven financial forecasting, grant intelligence, and operational efficiency create a buffer against revenue volatility—protecting the school's \$10.6M net asset position and 96% Charity Navigator rating.

Why Act Now

Four compounding pressures demand immediate action. Each force independently justifies AI investment; together they create an existential imperative.

Funding Volatility

\$1.7M clawback from DESE in December 2024 · Missouri charter funding formula under review (Task Force report due December 2026) · Per-pupil adequacy target jumped 10% to \$6,760 in 2025 · No taxing authority or bonding capacity for facilities

Teacher Supply Crisis

47/50 states report severe language teacher shortages · School cannot sponsor work visas—limiting international pipeline · 8–9 open positions currently posted · Teacher recruitment cited as the #1 reason French programs close nationally

Enrollment Growth Pressure

High school growing one grade per year toward 2,000+ student target · Waitlists exceed available seats at every entry point · Three-campus coordination increasingly complex · Student-teacher ratio already at 21:1

AI Adoption Accelerating

53% of teachers and 54% of students now use AI for school (RAND 2025) · AI in K–12 market projected to reach \$7.95B by 2033 at 38.1% CAGR · Superintendent Mbengue sits on Avila University's Strategic AI Program Advisory Board · No AI-specific tools in current stack

AI Applications Across SG&A Functions

Targeted AI deployment across every administrative function—delivering measurable efficiency gains and cost savings within 36 months.

	Finance & Accounting Automated state reporting and DESE compliance filings · AI-powered grant tracking and renewal intelligence · Cash flow forecasting with funding clawback scenario modeling · Invoice processing and purchase order automation \$150K–\$250K SAVINGS
	Enrollment & Development AI-generated fundraising communications and donor segmentation · Enrollment marketing content in English and French · Automated grant proposal drafting and funder matching · SchoolAppKC lottery analytics and yield optimization \$130K–\$220K SAVINGS
	Family Engagement Bilingual AI chatbot for parent inquiries (English/French) · Automated re-enrollment reminders via PowerSchool integration · 24/7 FAQ and school information assistant · Event and volunteer coordination automation \$80K–\$140K SAVINGS
	HR & Talent AI-powered international bilingual teacher sourcing and screening · Predictive retention analytics for at-risk educators · Automated onboarding workflows for staff from 23+ countries · Frontline substitute management optimization \$180K–\$300K SAVINGS
	Legal & Compliance Charter compliance documentation automation · IB MYP/DP portfolio and accreditation reporting via Toddle integration · Missouri Annual Performance Report preparation · FERPA and student data privacy monitoring \$70K–\$120K SAVINGS
	Curriculum & Assessment NWEA MAP assessment data analysis and adaptive learning recommendations · AI-assisted bilingual curriculum documentation · Student performance early-warning system · IB Diploma Programme preparation analytics and college readiness scoring \$140K–\$240K VALUE

Consolidated Financial Impact

Conservative estimates based on \$21.4M revenue, ~130 employees, and ~\$10M salary base. Low end assumes 50–60% of theoretical maximum; high end assumes 80–90%.

Function	Annual Value Range	Timeline
Finance & Accounting	\$150K – \$250K	6–12 months
HR & Talent	\$180K – \$300K	6–12 months
Enrollment & Development	\$130K – \$220K	6–12 months
Family Engagement	\$80K – \$140K	6–9 months
Legal & Compliance	\$70K – \$120K	9–15 months
Curriculum & Assessment	\$140K – \$240K	12–24 months
TOTAL IMPACT	\$750K – \$1.27M	36 months

\$200K

Investment Required

\$150K–\$250K over 36 months across three phases

4–7mo

Payback Period

Fastest payback in Phase 1 with finance and chatbot pilots

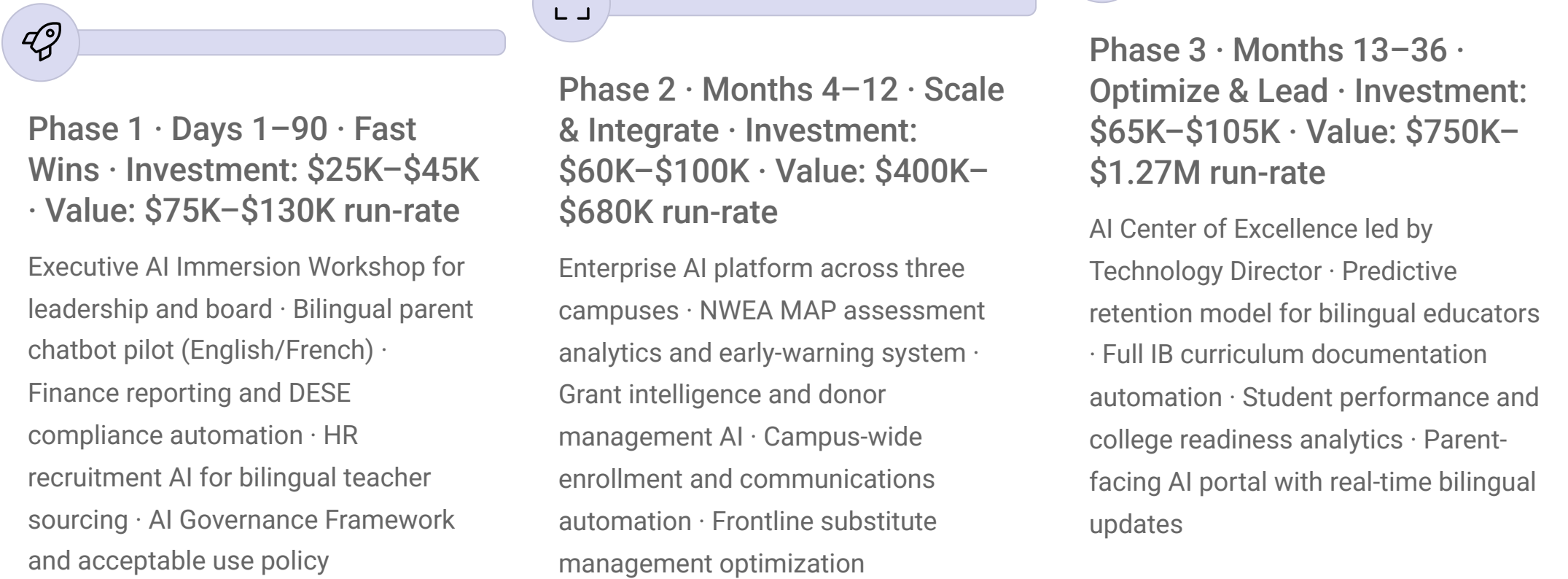
925%

3-Year ROI

800–1,050% return on AI investment over 36 months

Three-Phase Transformation

A structured 36-month roadmap designed to deliver immediate wins, scale enterprise-wide, and ultimately establish Académie Lafayette as a national model for AI-powered education.



Risk Management

Six identified risks with mitigation strategies embedded into the phased implementation plan.

1

Fragmented Adoption

Prob: HIGH · Three-campus structure increases coordination risk · AI Governance Framework in Phase 1 · Steering Committee with campus principal representation · Enterprise platform by Month 8

2

Data Quality Gaps

Prob: MEDIUM-HIGH · PowerSchool data readiness assessment in Phase 1 · Prioritize high-data-availability use cases (finance, enrollment) first · Google Workspace audit for staff data consistency

3

Change Resistance

Prob: MEDIUM · Staff from 23 countries with varying technology comfort · "AI augments educators, not replaces them" messaging · Tiered bilingual training for all staff · Superintendent Mbengue's AI advisory role provides credibility

4

Student Data Privacy (FERPA)

Impact: HIGH · Human-in-the-loop mandatory for all student-facing AI · FERPA compliance review for every tool · No student PII in AI training data · Private cloud for sensitive records

5

Vendor Lock-In

Prob: MEDIUM · Open APIs required · Multi-vendor strategy · Data portability in all contracts · Quarterly technology reviews aligned with PowerSchool ecosystem

6

Funding Volatility

Impact: HIGH · AI investments sized to remain viable under clawback scenarios · Phase 1 designed for immediate ROI before larger commitments · Financial forecasting AI specifically addresses revenue unpredictability

The Financial Sustainability Transformation

AI investment transforms Académie Lafayette's financial position—creating cumulative capacity of **\$2.2M–\$3.9M over 3 years** and expanding strategic optionality across every dimension of school operations.

TODAY

\$1.72M Net Surplus

8.0% operating margin

\$21.4M Revenue · \$19.7M Expenses
Net Assets: \$10.6M

- \$1.7M clawback fully absorbed operating surplus
- Administrative costs scale linearly with enrollment
- Manual bilingual teacher recruitment pipeline
- No AI-specific tools in technology stack

YEAR 3 · POST-AI

\$2.47M–\$2.99M Net Surplus

10.5–12.5% operating margin

\$750K–\$1.27M in annual AI-driven savings added to baseline
Net Assets: \$13.5M–\$15.8M · Estimate

- Future clawbacks fully offset by AI savings
- Scale to 2,000+ students on existing SG&A infrastructure
- Self-fund facility improvements beyond \$13.6M bond
- \$2.2M–\$3.9M cumulative financial capacity created

Absorb Funding Clawbacks

\$1.7M clawback would be fully offset by AI savings—no program cuts required

Scale to 2,000+ Students

Support high school growth plan on existing SG&A infrastructure without proportional hiring

Self-Fund Facilities

Reduce dependence on philanthropic capital campaigns for operational needs beyond the bond

The Choice Is Clear

❌ OPTION A: STATUS QUO

The Cost of Inaction

- Funding clawbacks erode net surplus
- Bilingual teacher pipeline remains manual and constrained
- Administrative costs scale linearly with enrollment growth
- 2,000-student target requires proportional headcount increases

✅ OPTION B: AI TRANSFORMATION

The Path Forward

- **\$750K–\$1.27M annual operational savings**
- 10.5–12.5% operating margin (up from 8.0%)
- **\$2.2M–\$3.9M cumulative financial capacity** over 3 years
- Scale to 2,000+ students on existing administrative infrastructure

Immediate Next Steps — Week 1

1

Day 1–3

Superintendent Mbengue convenes leadership team · Secure board endorsement · Commit to Phase 1 investment plan

2

Week 1

Engage AI consulting partner · Assign Phase 1 lead (Director of Finance or Director of HR) · Allocate \$25K–\$45K Phase 1 budget

3

Week 1–2

School-wide communication: AI as a tool to support educators and families · Invite staff input across all three campuses

4

Week 2–4

Select Phase 1 pilots (parent chatbot + finance automation) · Begin Executive Immersion training for leadership and board

"Académie Lafayette didn't become Missouri's #1-ranked school by standing still. The same boldness that launched a charter school in 1999 now demands an AI-first approach to reaching 2,000 students."